

How to Use Notion to build a Kanban Board for Project Management

Audience Analysis

The intended audience for these instructions is college students and early-career individuals who want to organize tasks but have little to no experience using project management tools like Notion. Most users are familiar with basic tools such as Google Docs or simple to-do lists but may not understand how to structure a workspace or track progress across multiple tasks in a more dynamic system. They are likely looking for a simple, reliable method to manage assignments, personal projects, or work responsibilities without feeling overwhelmed by complex features.

Users will typically follow these instructions on a laptop while switching between Notion and other applications such as a web browser, email, or school platforms. Because they may be multitasking or working in distracting environments, they need instructions that are easy to scan and quick to follow. They may also be working under time constraints, which increases the need for clear, efficient guidance. Long explanations or unclear steps may lead to confusion, frustration, or incorrect setup.

To accommodate this audience, the instructions use short, direct commands and break the process into clearly defined steps that can be completed one at a time. Visual screenshots are included to reduce confusion and help users quickly identify features within Notion's interface without excessive searching. The guide avoids technical jargon and focuses on a simple, functional setup that users can easily replicate and expand later as they become more comfortable with the platform.

Introduction

Notion is an all-in-one productivity tool that helps users organize tasks, manage projects, and track progress visually. This guide explains how to create a simple project management system using a Kanban-style board. A Kanban board is a visual system that organizes tasks into columns based on their progress, such as "To Do," "In Progress," and "Done." Tasks are represented as cards that can be moved between columns as work is completed, making it easy to see what needs to be done and what has already been finished.

Tools Needed

- Notion account (free; a paid version is available but not required)
- Laptop or desktop computer
- Internet connection

Important Tips

- Start with a simple board to avoid confusion
- Keep task names short and clear

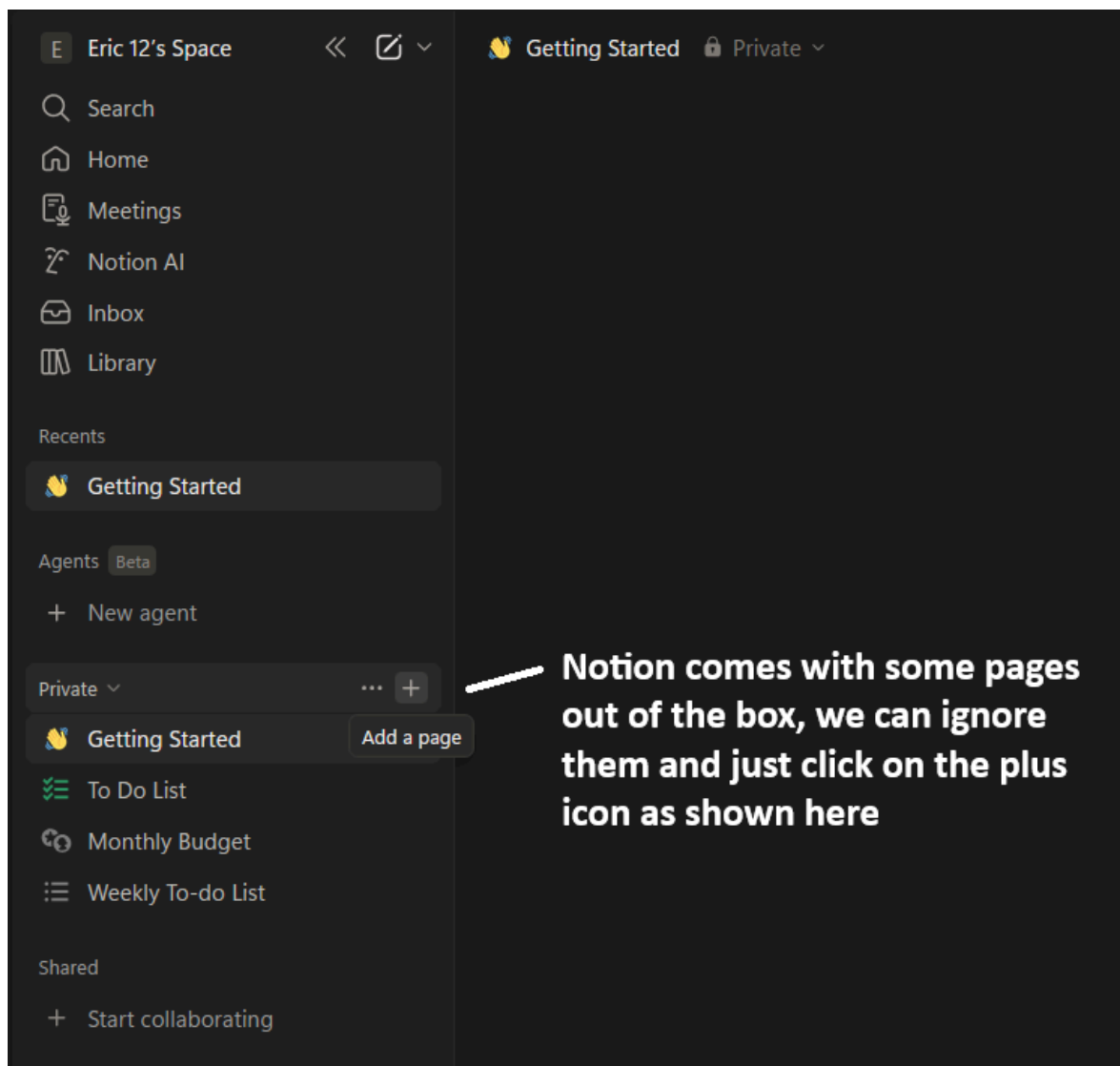
- Update your board regularly
- Using tags improves organization and helps you manage tasks more effectively
- You can create separate boards for different purposes, such as personal tasks, schoolwork, or team projects

Instructions

Step 1: Create a New Page

Open Notion and log in. Click “+ Add a page” in the sidebar. Type a title such as “Project Tracker” and press Enter.

Image 1. Creating a new page

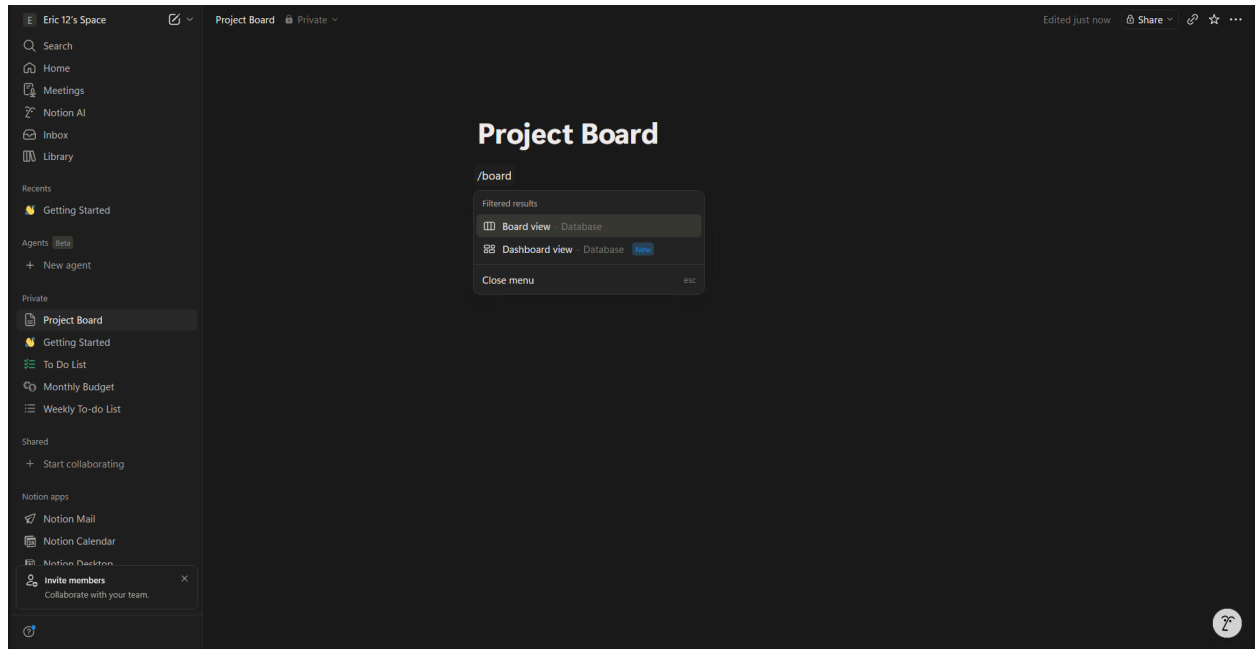


Caption: Click “Add a page” in the sidebar to create a new workspace.

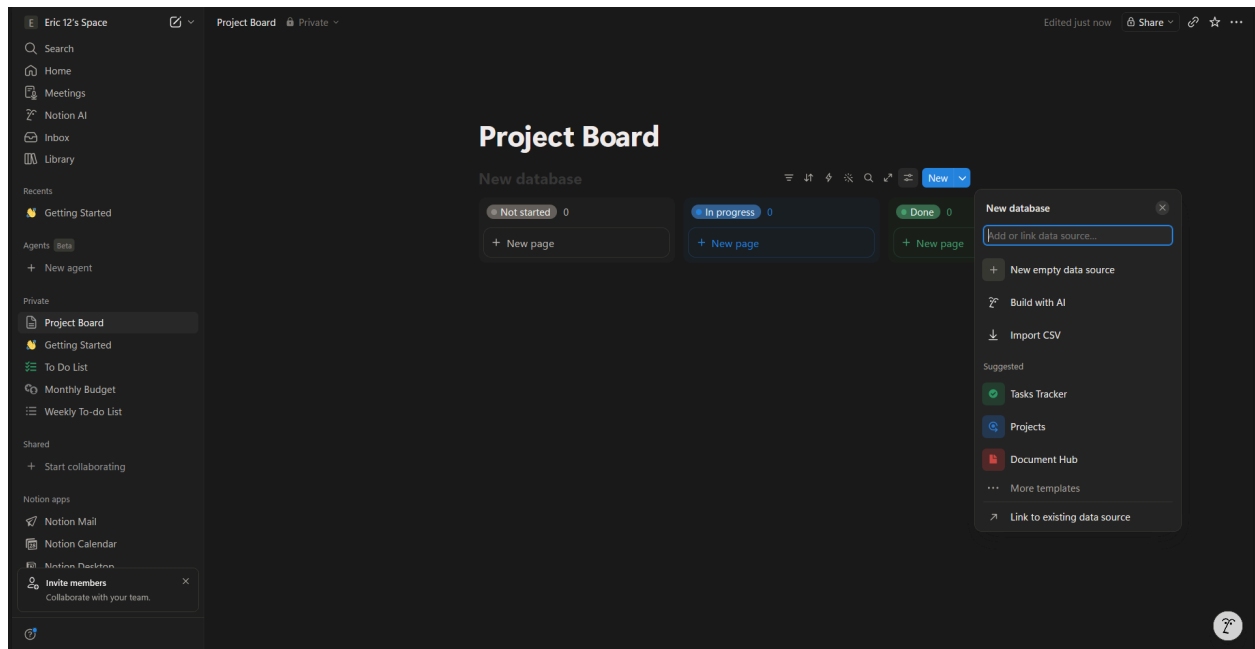
Step 2: Insert a Board Database

Click inside the blank page. Type `/board` and select **“Board view”** Wait for the board to load.

Image 2. Selecting the board database



Caption: Use the command menu to insert a board layout.



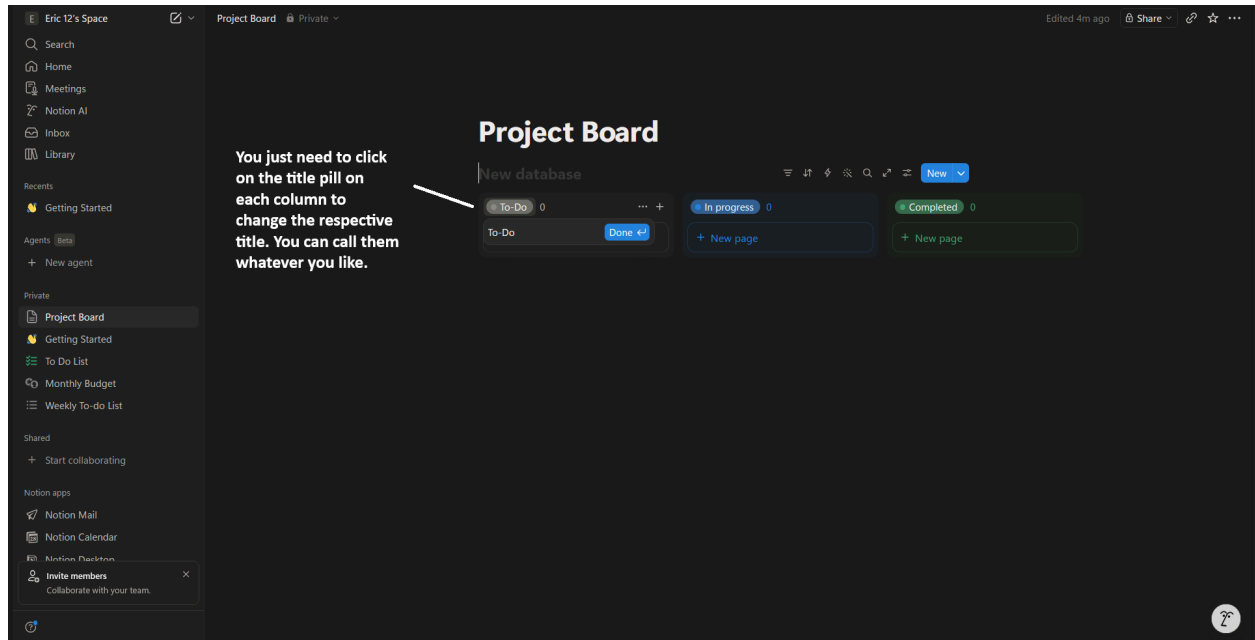
Caption: The board appears with default columns after inserting the database.

Step 3: Rename the Columns

Rename each column to match your workflow. For this guide, use the following:

- To Do
- In Progress
- Completed

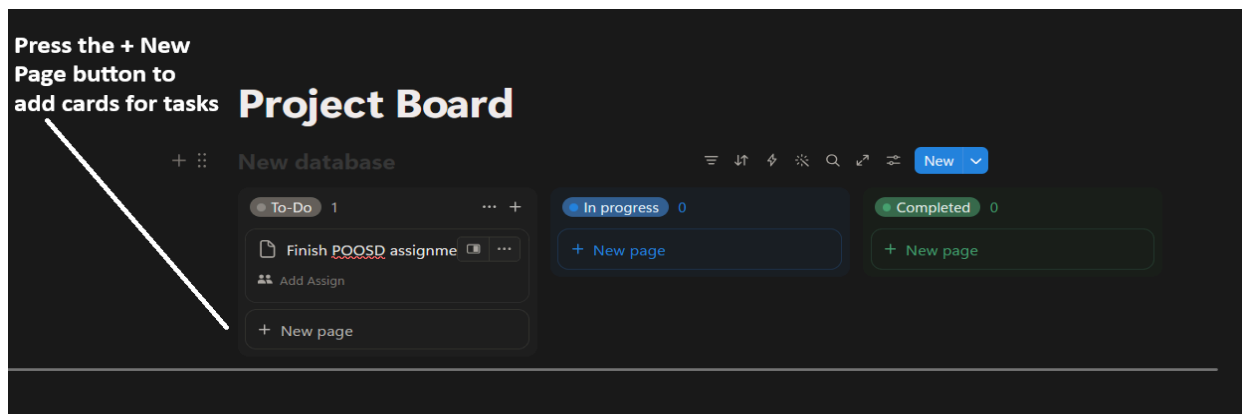
Image 3. Renaming columns



Caption: Rename columns to match task stages.

Step 4: Add a Task

Click “+ New” under the “To Do” column. Type a task name such as *Finish assignment*. Press Enter to save.

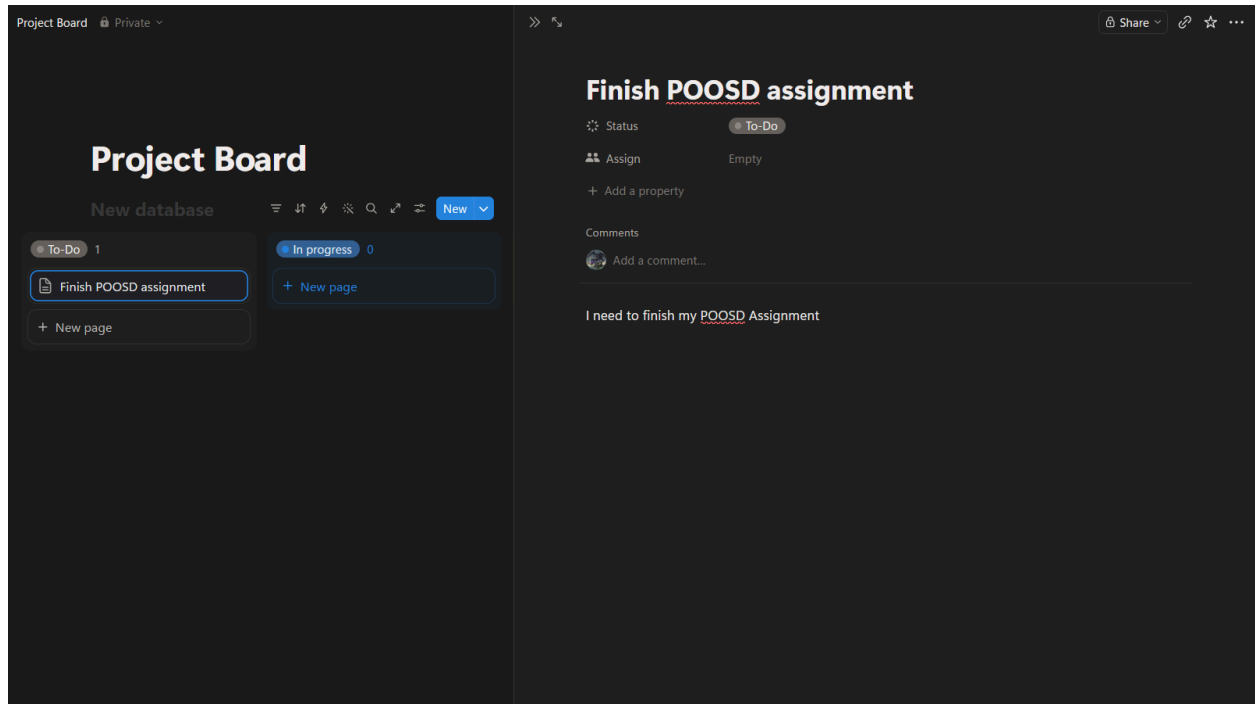


Caption: Click “+ New” to create a new task card in the selected column.

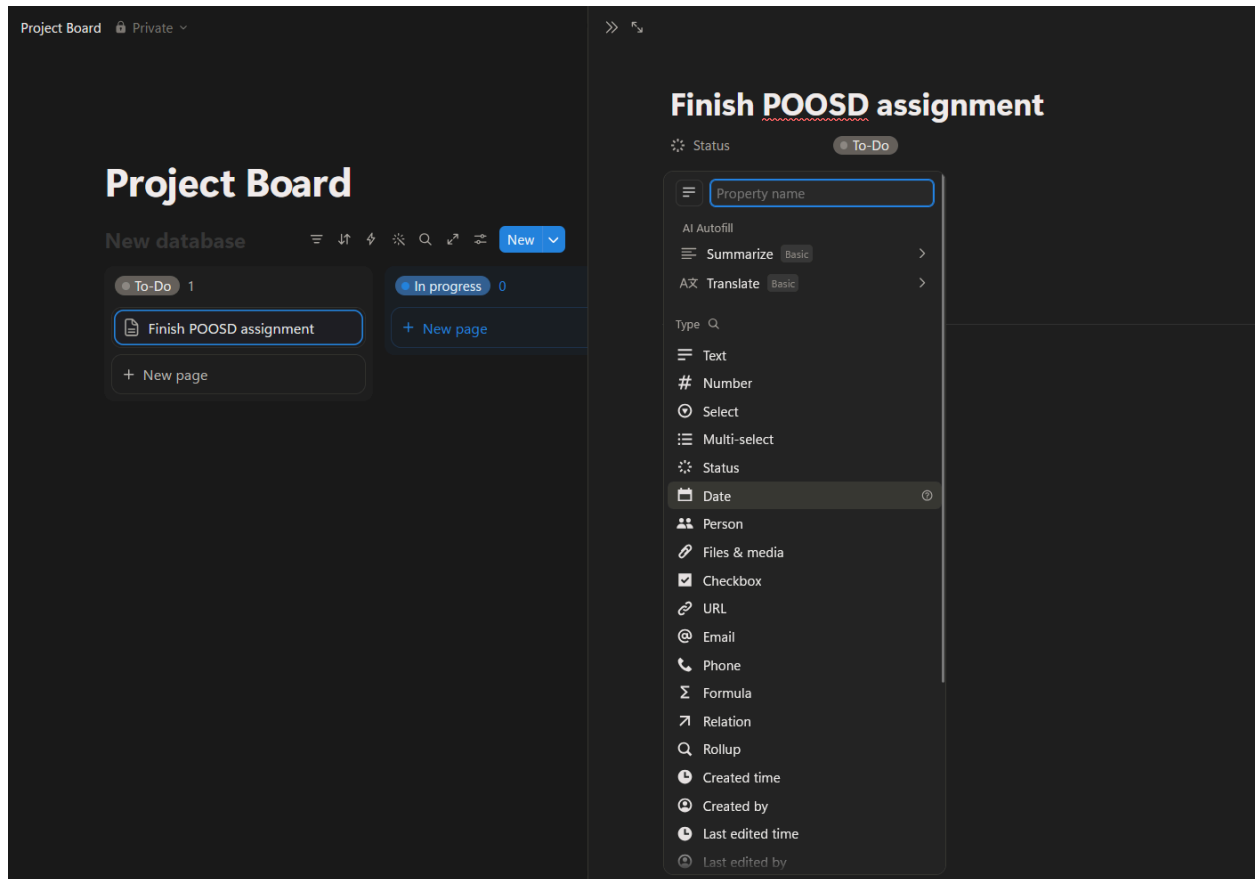
Step 5: Add Task Details

Click a task card to open it. Type a description. Click **“Add a property”** → **Date** to assign a due date.

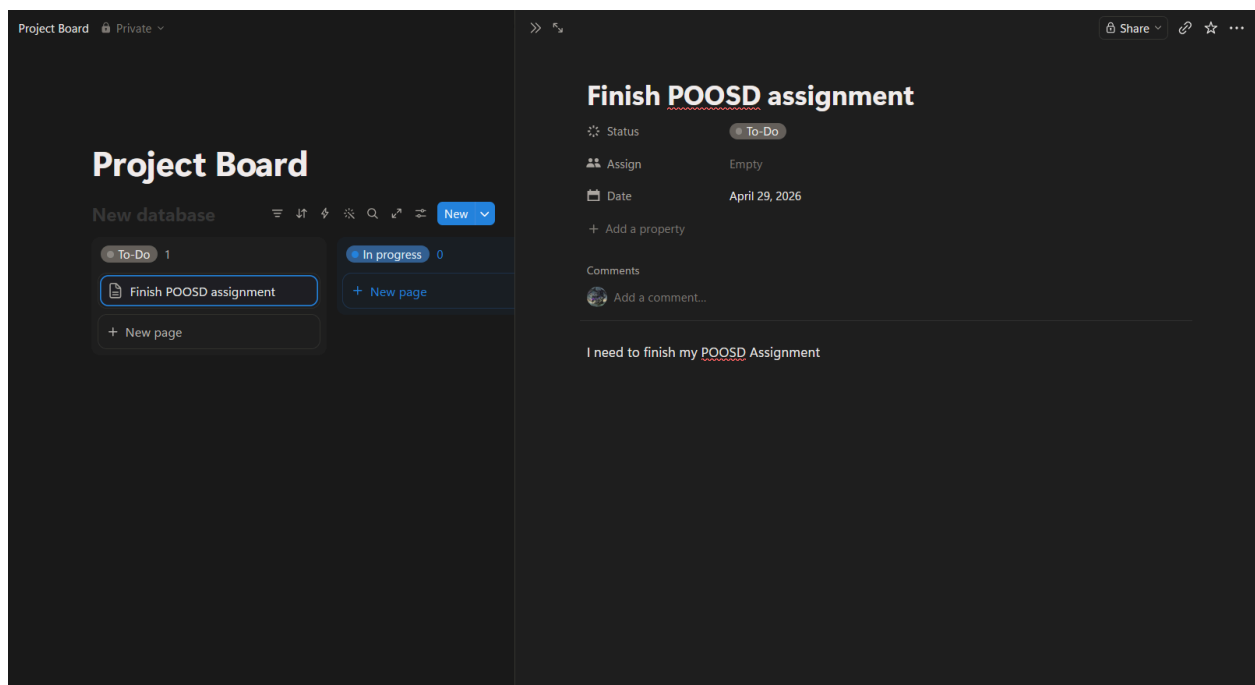
Image 4. Editing a task card



Caption: Open a task card to add details like descriptions and due dates.



Caption: Click on “+ Add a property” below status and select date

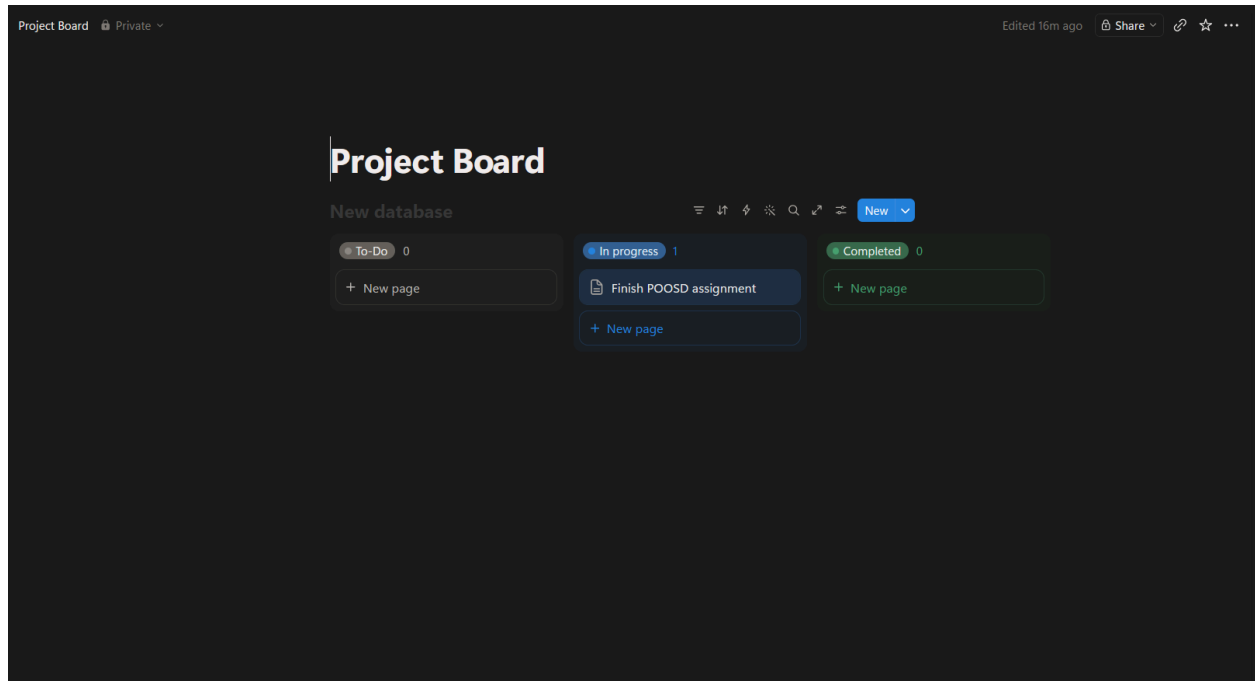


Caption: Select a due date and save it to update the task details.

Step 6: Move Tasks Across Columns

Click and drag a task card. Move it from **To Do** → **In Progress** → **Done** as you complete it.

Image 5. Moving tasks

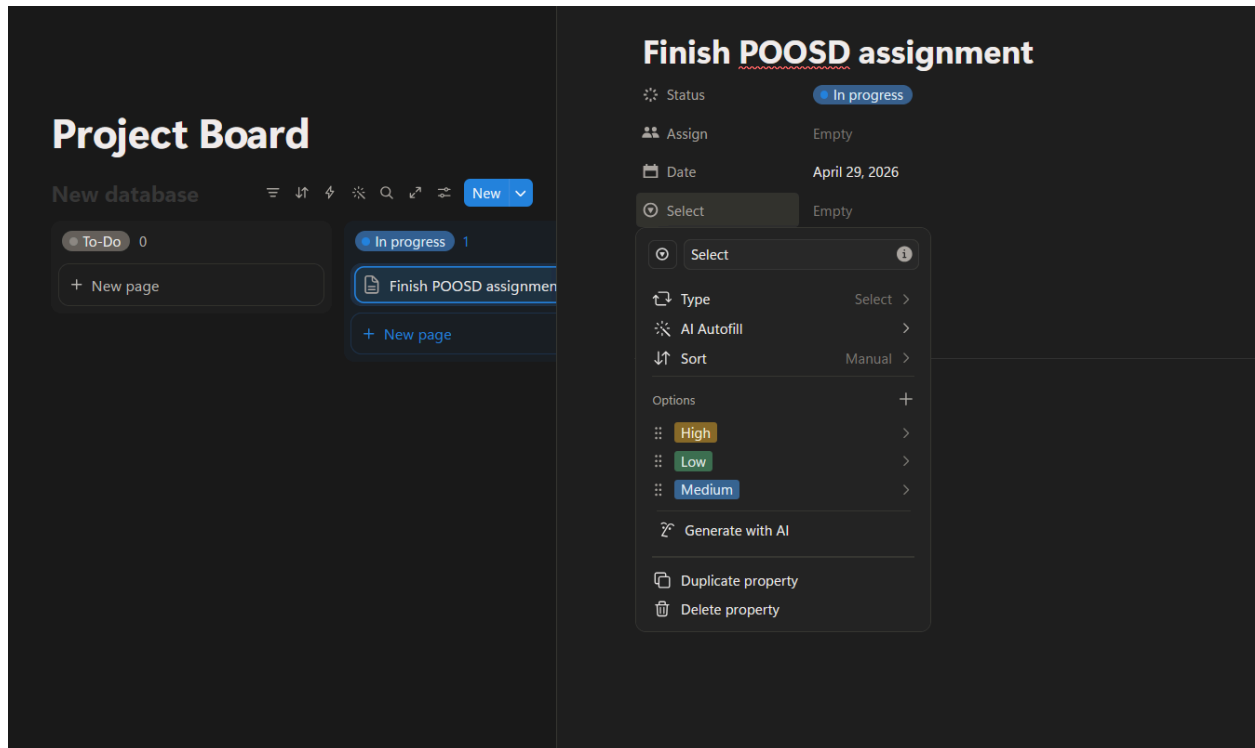


Caption: Drag tasks to update their progress.

Step 7: Add Priority or Tags (Optional)

After opening the task card. Select **Add a property -> Select**. Name it Priority and add options such as High, Medium, and Low. Repeat to add tags like School or Work.

Image 6. Adding properties



Caption: Click “+ Add a property” to add a priority property, or any other fields you want.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Adding too many columns, which makes the board harder to use
- Forgetting to update task progress
- Adding unnecessary details that clutter the workspace
- Not using tags can make it more difficult to distinguish between different types of tasks

Conclusion

You have created a simple project management system using Notion. This setup allows you to track tasks visually and stay organized. As you become more comfortable, you can expand your system by adding calendars, timelines, or additional properties.

Glossary

- **Kanban Board:** A visual system for tracking tasks across stages
- **Database:** A structured collection of information in Notion
- **Property:** A field used to store additional task information